

Second trimester

13 WEEKS Changes inside your body mean that you are glowing now. Sit back and enjoy this settled period.



Baby watch

📏 3½ in (8.7 cm) ⚖️ 1½ oz (43 g)

Your baby will begin to look more in proportion as the torso starts to lengthen. The hands and feet are no longer webbed, toenails continue to develop, and the numerous bones of the hands and feet start to form.

Mom matters

The hormone relaxin is softening your joints and ligaments in preparation for birth. The downside is the added strain on your ligaments; you may start to feel some discomfort. As your blood volume continues to increase, your skin may start to take on the characteristic pregnancy “glow;” this, together with your more noticeable belly can start to signal to others that you’re pregnant.



This week...

» Now is a great time to take a vacation if you want, while you feel more energetic and are not uncomfortably big. Most airlines don’t let women fly in advanced pregnancy, so check their latest dates for flying before you buy a ticket.

» Keep a diary or photo journal of your pregnancy. You can record your growing belly, feelings, and changing symptoms.

» Keep up your regular exercise if it is gentle enough. Walking and swimming are ideal, and moderate jogging is fine if you’re used to this.

14 WEEKS Your pregnancy may be becoming obvious, and you may feel an incredible sense of well-being.



Baby watch

📏 4 in (10.1 cm) ⚖️ 2½ oz (70 g)

The umbilical cord, your baby’s lifeline, is growing thicker and longer as it transports an increasing volume of oxygen-rich blood and nutrients to your baby. In baby girls, the ovaries are forming thousands of eggs, and the ovaries themselves are moving down into the pelvis. The external genitalia are increasingly visible now, and could possibly be seen on an ultrasound.

Mom matters

It’s not uncommon to have a permanently stuffy nose, nosebleeds, and sinus headaches. These are caused by the extra blood flow to the mucous membranes. New symptoms may emerge such as constipation and indigestion. These are thought to be side effects of the hormones that make your digestive system sluggish.



This week...

» You may need to shop for some pregnancy clothes since waistbands may be growing too tight.

» If you have been referred for diagnostic tests such as CVS or amniocentesis, they could be done around this time.

» You are not obliged to tell your employer about your pregnancy, but discussing it sooner means you can talk through plans. Approach your boss or human resources.

15 WEEKS It is normal to have mixed feelings about your changing body shape and curves.



Baby watch

📏 4½ in (11.6 cm) ⚖️ 3½ oz (100 g)

Your baby’s kidneys are functioning and can filter blood and eliminate waste from the body. The messages from the baby’s brain and the rest of the body travel with more speed, allowing for more coordinated actions, including slow eye movements.

Mom matters

In addition to glowing skin, you may also find that your hair is fuller and more glossy as hormonal conditions prolong the growth phase of hair and less hair falls out on a daily basis than usual. Nails become healthier and stronger too.



This week...

» If you don’t already exercise, put a gentle, regular exercise regimen into place. Now is a good time to start a pregnancy yoga class.

» It’s not too early to start thinking about your birth plan—where you would like to give birth, who you would like to be with you, and birthing techniques you might consider.

» If you plan to take one enroll in childbirth classes this week, if you haven’t done so already. These don’t start until later in pregnancy but can fill up quickly. Your doctor can give you details of hospital and private classes.

» Try to set aside time for you and your partner.